

MERIDIAN WORKS TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY & ARCHITECTURE

FIELD GUIDE · V1.0 · MARCH 2027

TS&A LINE

PLANT PLAN

The works plan for Meridian technology

One target state. Every plant aligned. Everything you keep asking about, in one place.

THE WORKS
6 plants, 4 product families, one plan

ROUTE
Apr 2027 to Dec 2028, then every year after

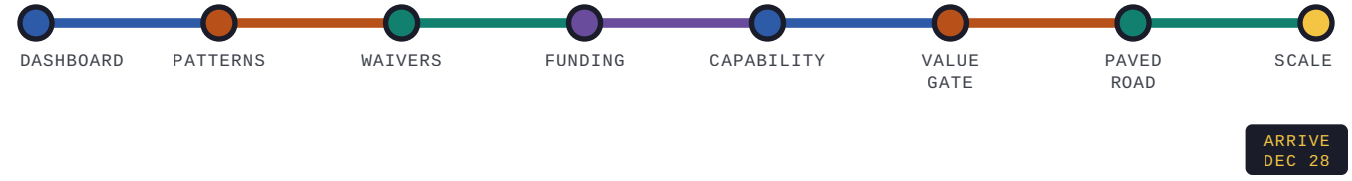
READERS
Anyone who has asked "where is the RACI?"

WHAT'S IN THE PLAN

- 1 charter
- 3 processes
- 1 team structure
- 1 shift pattern
- 1 CONOPS
- 1 roadmap
- 1 RACI
- 9 success measures

Prepared by E. Okafor, Head of Technology Strategy & Architecture, for the Meridian Works leadership team

FIRST STOP: PAGE 02



Dear reader,

You have asked great questions: Do you have your CONOPS? Where is the RACI? When will my plant get an architect? This guide answers them in one place, and it is yours to keep.

One target state. Every plant aligned. Technology Strategy & Architecture exists for four outcomes: invest in what matters, deliver faster, simplify the estate, and take risk on purpose. Every standard, roadmap and review in this guide traces back to one of them.

I wrote this guide as a works plan, because that is how the work runs. TS&A draws the plant layout and sets the tolerances. Plants and product teams design and build within them. The ARB is the inspection gate for the work that shapes the whole line. A works runs when everyone builds to the same plan.

Find your stop

The answer key on page 3 takes you straight to the right page.

Bring it with you

Use it in our meetings. Write in the margins.

Make it better

Tell us what is missing. Version 1.1 gets better because of you.

Thank you for your partnership. Let's build.

E. Okafor, Head of Technology Strategy & Architecture

Find your stop

Every question we have been asked more than twice, and the page that answers it. Skip the meeting and ride straight to the page.

What is this team, and what is it for?
STOP 04

Where are we headed?
STOP 05

What does the team look like?
STOP 06

Where is the RACI?
STOP 07

Do you have a roadmap?
STOP 08

How will you measure success?
STOP 09

What are you assuming?
STOP 10

What does that term mean?
STOP 11

What do you need from me?
STOP 12

How to read this guide. Each stop answers one question on one page. The color bar at the top of every stop is the pillar that owns the answer: Strategy, Architecture, Governance, Performance.

Acronyms and terms: stop 11.

How the works runs

The plan: make Meridian's $310M technology and operational-technology estate, including $26M a year in capital projects, work as one works. We are the strategy and enterprise architecture authority for Meridian Works: 6 plants, 4 product families and 2 shared platforms, one target state.

THE FOUR PILLARS

S Strategy

Where we are going: strategy on a page, objectives at every level, investment priorities.

A Architecture

What good looks like: target state, standards, patterns, capability model, roadmaps.

G Governance

How decisions get made and stay made: the ARB, the CoP and waivers.

P Performance

Proof it works: measures, baselines, monthly dashboard, quarterly value review.

HOW WE PLAN: PARTNER FIRST, AUTHORITY IN RESERVE

1 Collaborate
Build the relationship first. Show up useful.

2 Codify
Turn what we learn into shared standards and models.

3 Convene
An ARB people choose to attend because it helps.

4 Conform
Adoption is the norm because teams want the north star.

WHAT A WELL-RUN WORKS DELIVERS

Invest in what matters

Shared direction and reuse turn each dollar toward the plan.

Deliver faster

Paved roads remove waiting from design, review and release.

Simplify the estate

Fewer platforms, fewer variants, less to patch and protect.

Take risk on purpose

Every exception is visible and owned, with an expiry date.

The destination: one target state

By the end of 2028, Meridian plans, builds and invests from one shared target state. We design from the destination and keep a minimum viable baseline: only as much of today as each next step needs.

* One practice

Every plant and platform architects from the same playbook, steering Meridian together.

= One standards baseline

An approved stack that every team builds on, and that plants tailor to their line.

@ One enterprise view

A shared target state that everyone plans toward, built from the data we already have.

% Capability-led investment

Capability roadmaps shape product boundaries and inform every funding decision.

+ Paved roads

Approved patterns and automated checks make the right way the fast way. The ARB focuses on what is truly significant.

A real architecture discipline

Clear career paths in architecture, and a named architect for every product team.

! Risk taken on purpose

Every exception is visible and owned, with an expiry date.

$ Value you can see

Agreed targets, a monthly dashboard and a quarterly value review with the executive team.

WHY NOW

Board direction: standardize and centralize wherever possible to speed up delivery.

Jan 2028: Wave 1 of the product operating model starts, with architects placed as the catalog lands.

2028 priorities: automation, the plant digital core and the connected product line all build on this target state.

The drafting office

Technology Strategy & Architecture: five direct leads across four pillars, with plant architects connected by a dotted line.

H Head of TS&A

Owns the plan, the charter and the relationship with the executive team.

S Strategy Lead

Strategy on a page, objectives at every level, investment priorities.

C Chief Architect

Target state, standards and the architecture roadmap. Directs the plant architects.

B Business Architect

The capability model: what Meridian does, mapped to what it needs.

G Governance Lead

Runs the ARB and the CoP. Owns waivers and the decision log.

P Performance Lead

Measures, baselines, the monthly dashboard and the quarterly value review.

Plant architects sit in the plants and report to plant engineering; they take their architecture direction from the Chief Architect and sit on the CoP. The drafting office stays small on purpose: twelve people, four of them part-time from the plants.

The RACI: strategy and architecture

A Accountable, one per row R Responsible D Decides by vote C Consulted I Informed

DECISION OR ACTIVITY	CIO	Head of TS&A	Strategy Lead	Chief Architect	Plant Architects	ARB	Engineering	Security
STRATEGY								
Meridian technology strategy on a page	A	R	R	C	C	-	I	C
Investment priorities and portfolio alignment	A	R	R	C	C	-	C	C
Which AI and automation use cases we pursue	I	C	C	R	C	-	C	C
ARCHITECTURE								
Enterprise target state	I	A	-	R	C	C	C	C
Standards and approved stack	I	A	-	R	C	D	C	C
Reference architectures and patterns	-	A	-	C	R	C	C	C
Capability model and capability roadmaps	I	A	C	R	C	-	C	-
Solution design, within standards	-	I	-	C	R	-	A	C
Security policy and operations	-	I	-	C	C	-	C	A Plant OT

A tag under a letter names the one that holds it. Plant architects work under the Chief Architect.

The route map: Q2 2027 to Q4 2028

	STAND UP Q2 2027	PROVE VALUE · GATE DEC 2027 Q3 2027 Q4 2027	SCALE 2028
MILESTONES	◆ **Apr:** Wave 1 of the product model starts	◆ **Sep:** Standards v1.0 in pipelines ◆ **Dec:** Value gate	
Governance	ARB every two weeks and CoP monthly from Apr 2027.	Every review and waiver logged; automated checks piloted in two plants.	ARB sees only significant items; waivers expire on schedule.
Standards	Standards v1.0 drafted.	Standards v1.0 approved; templates and automated checks piloted.	Checks in every pipeline; teams self-serve patterns.
Architectures	Named architects for Waves 1 and 2 plants.	Target state and capability roadmaps v1.0 for all plants.	Product architects named 30, 60, 90 days after the catalog.
Team	Roles opened Apr 2027; all seats filled by Jun 30.	TOGAF and C4 training for every architect.	Capability architects grow from 3 to 8.
Value	Set value baselines.	Targets agreed Jan 2028, a monthly dashboard and a quarterly value review.	Roadmaps inform quarterly product funding.

APR 2027	Centralization announced. TS&A roles opened.
JUN 2027	All TS&A seats filled by Jun 30. Value baselines set. Standards v1.0 drafted.
DEC 2027	Capability and architecture roadmaps v1.0. Value gate.
JUN 2028	Roadmaps feed Q3 funding. Automated checks in pipelines in most plants.
DEC 2028	Every product team has a named architect. 2029 architecture roadmap.

Measuring the works

A healthy practice makes decisions that change the estate. That gives us nine measures: three early signals, three proofs of value, and three health checks on the practice itself.

EARLY SIGNALS

Decisions with EA input
Product capacity decisions made with EA input, counted monthly.

Teams on paved roads
Percent of product teams building on approved patterns.

Design review turnaround
Median days from submission to decision.

PROOFS OF VALUE

Investments changed
Investments EA merged, reused or stopped, in dollars, per quarter.

Cycle time
Days from design approval to production, trended per plant.

Estate simplified
Applications retired and end-of-life exposure removed.

HEALTH CHECKS

Waivers aging
Open waivers past their expiry date: target zero.

Architect coverage
Percent of product teams with a named architect.

CoP participation
Active contributors per month across all six plants.

Assumptions and constraints

What we assume, who confirms it, and what changes if it does not hold. Reviewed every quarter.

ASSUMPTIONS TO CONFIRM

#	WE ASSUME	CONFIRMED BY	BY	IF IT CHANGES, SEE
1	Engineering's role in standards and practice, and how it works with EA.	Chief Engineer	Dec 2027	RACI, solution design (07); roadmap, Governance (08)
2	Plant IT leads give the Chief Architect a seat in plant planning and grant metadata access to the estate inventory.	VP Manufacturing	Dec 2027	Destination (05); measures (09)
3	The product catalog publishes on the announced date, so product architects can be placed in Waves 2 and 3.	Product Council	Jan 2028	Roadmap, Architectures (08)
4	No new tooling money is needed in 2027; deliverables live in tools Meridian already owns.	CIO	Apr 2027	Charter (04)

The works glossary

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
ARB	Architecture Review Board. Decides significant designs, new standards and exceptions.
CoP	Community of Practice. Where every architect in Meridian learns, shares and shapes how we build.
CONOPS	Concept of operations. How the function runs day to day.
Minimum viable baseline	Only as much of today's estate as each next step needs, documented and kept current.
Paved road	An approved, automated path: patterns and checks that make the right way the fast way.
Target state	The shared picture of where the estate is headed, that everyone plans toward.
Value gate	The scheduled review where results are shown against agreed targets and the next phase is funded or stopped.
Waiver	A recorded exception to a standard, with an owner and an expiry date.

Start of production: your part

GRAND OPENING · DEC 2028

Every product team builds on paved roads, the ARB sees only what is truly significant, and the quarterly value review shows results against the targets we agreed.

YOUR FOUR PARTS

1

Sign the charter

This is the one thing we need to start on time.

TODAY · MAR 2027

2

Set targets with us

Agree the value targets you will hold us to.

MAY 2027

3

Use the ARB

Bring it significant decisions, new standards and exceptions. Every exception gets an owner and an expiry date.

EVERY 2 WEEKS

4

Hold us to the measures

Read the monthly dashboard. Ask about the red ones.

MONTHLY

Thank you for your partnership. Let's build.